

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 136

By Seal

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Reverend William L. Swafford.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Reverend William L. Swafford of Talbott, a veteran, religious leader, inspiring pastor, humble servant of God, and faithful friend; and

WHEREAS, after serving in the U.S. Navy during the Cold War era, Reverend Swafford studied at Belmont College and then at the Southern Baptist Theological Seminary in Louisville, Kentucky; and

WHEREAS, serving as a pastor for seventy years, Reverend Swafford led the people of Talbott Baptist Church to cherish the things of heaven and not cling to the things of earth, and through his long service on several committees of the Tennessee Baptist Convention, the effects of his shepherding surpassed the local confines of his congregation; and

WHEREAS, he was known as a man of God and led his people to discover the graces in this pilgrimage, and he confirmed and comforted his people in faith, whether marking the new beginnings of marriages or commemorating at funerals those who have fallen asleep; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Swafford actively cultivated his God-given talents, and his artistry in woodworking is a testament to his multifarious skillset; and

WHEREAS, a true servant-leader, Reverend Swafford generously gave much of his time volunteering in local senior centers, and he always manifested a loving care that revealed the effect of grace within him; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his good work from the pulpit and beyond, Reverend Swafford was wholly devoted to his family and friends, and he is still cherished and remembered by his son, Jeff (Michelle) Swafford; his daughter, Patrice Swafford Welch; his grandchildren, Ashley

Swafford, Julia Welch Riddle, Lauren Burress, and Patrick Welch; his several great-grandchildren; a host of nieces and nephews; his special friend, Charlie Roesser; numerous other friends; and many others whose lives he touched; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, James Swafford and Lestial Dooley Swafford, he was preceded in death by his beloved wife, Yvonne Malone Swafford, and his brother, Carlton D. Swafford; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Swafford served his faith and his community with distinction for seven decades, and he should be remembered for his many contributions and the example he set for others; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Reverend William L. Swafford, reflecting fondly upon his resolute service to God and humanity, and extend our sympathy and condolences to his family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.